



How can cross-organization and cross-sector collaboration be facilitated for joined-up action?

There are many situations when one wants to make sure that a number of different organizations or initiatives are working together to achieve shared outcomes. One example is government agencies and publically funded providers working across a sector. The same issue will become increasingly important when orchestrating a mix of human and AI agents to achieve shared outcomes.

In the government setting, politicians often restructure, amalgamate, and create or disband government agencies in an attempt to improve resource allocation and get government agencies to focus on the priorities they consider important. Some government agency restructuring has to be done from time to time. New government agencies need to be set up to meet new needs and old ones closed down when there is no longer a need. However, excessive restructuring can sap morale within the agencies that are being restructured.

Before decision-makers move to restructure government agencies, they should consider using this Multiple Initiatives or Agents With Shared Outcomes DoView Strategy/Outcomes Diagram Coordination Tool (B19). This can be used to coordinate activity being undertaken by different agencies and their external providers which are focused on achieving some or all of the same steps and outcomes. This type of approach is conceptually similar to what is called Collective Impact.

Using this approach in government, government agencies and providers that are funded by them are asked to show how they are contributing to a cross-agency DoView strategy/outcomes diagram. When this tool is employed correctly, it will concentrate government agency and provider's minds on showing that what they are doing is focused on the priority cross-agency and provider priorities that are being sought by politicians.

The tool will become increasingly valuable in coordinating the activity of human and AI agents as we move forward. The new AI saturated environment will need tools like this that can deal with non-traditional working groups of humans and AI agents coming together as ad hoc project groups to work on shared outcomes.